11. With reference to the period of Indian freedom struggle, which of the following was/were recommended by the Nehru report ?

1. **Complete Independence for India.**
2. **Joint electorates for reservation of seats for minorities .**
3. **Provision of fundamental rights for the people of Indian in the Constitution.**

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): On 11 May, 1928, at the Second All Party Conference in Mumbai, a seven-member committee was set up under the chairmanship of Pt. Motilal Nehru to determine the principles of the Constitution of India. The recommendation made in the report were as follows–

(i) Dominion status to India.
(ii) India will be a union under whose control there will be a bicameral legislature at the centre, the cabinet will be responsible to the house.
(iii) The position of Governor- General shall be that of a constitutional head.
(iv) The demand for a separate electorate on the communal ground was rejected.
(v) Fundamental rights are defined by defining citizenship.

GEOGRAPHY OF INDIA

• Physical Structure/Drainage System/ Human Geography

12. Two important rivers–one with its source in Jharkhand (and known by a different name in Odisha), and another, with its source in Odisha merge at a place only a short distance from the coast of Bay of Bengal before flowing into the Sea. This is an important site of wildlife and biodiversity and a protected area. Which one of the following could be this?

(a) Bhitarkanika (b) Chandipur-on-sea
(c) Gopalpur-on-sea (d) Simlipal

Ans. (a): The Bhitarkanika Mangroves are a mangrove wetland in India's Odisha state. The Bhitarkanika Mangroves cover an area of 650 km^2 in the river delta of the Brahmani and Baitarani rivers.

13. La Nina is suspected to have caused recent floods in Australia. How is La Nina different from El Nino.

1. **La Nina is characterized by unusually cold ocean temperature in equatorial Indian Ocean whereas El Nino is characterized by unusually warm ocean temperature in the equatorial Pacific Ocean.**
2. **El Nino has adverse effect on south–west monsoon of India, but La Nina has no effect on monsoon climate.**

Which of the statement given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d): La Nina is a cold current flowing across the west coast of South America. It is characterized by the low and high pressure prevailing in the Pacific Ocean. Low pressure in that region bring goods monsoon to the Indian subcontinent.

14. Salinisation occurs when the irrigation water accumulated in the soil evaporates, leaving behind salts and minerals. What are the effects of salinization on the irrigated land ?

(a) It greatly increases the crop production
(b) It makes some soils impermeable
(c) It raises the water table
(d) It fills the air spaces in the soil with water

Ans. (b): The saline of the soil is generated from the salt and minerals left behind due to evaporation of the irrigated water collected in the soil. Soil becomes inaccessible due to salinization on the irrigated land.

15. The lower Gangetic plain is characterized by humid climate with high temperature throughout the year. Which one among the following pairs of crops is most suitable for this region ?

(a) Paddy and Cotton (b) Wheat and Jute
(c) Paddy and Jute (d) Wheat and Cotton

Ans. (c) : The most important feature of the lower gangetic plains is that the climate here remains humid with high temperatures throughout the year, making this area the most suitable for paddy and jute crops.

16. The Brahmaputras, Irrawady and Mekong rivers originate in Tibet and flow through narrow and parallel mountain ranges in their upper reaches.

Of these rivers. Brahmaputra makes a ''U'' turn in its course to flow into India .This ''U'' turn is due to :

(a) Uplift of folded Himalayan series
(b) Syntaxial bending of geologically young Himalayas'
(c) Geo-tectonic disturbance in the tertiary folded mountain chains
(d) Both (a) and (b)

Ans. (b): The Brahmaputra, Irrawaddy and Mekong rivers have their origins in Tibet. They flow through narrow and parallel mountain ranges. The Brahmaputra takes a U-turn before entering India; this U-turn is due to syntaxial bending of the geologically young Himalayas.

17. A state in India has the following characteristics :

1. **Its northern part is arid and semiarid.**
2. **Its central part produces cotton.**
3. **Cultivation of cash crops is predominant over food crops.**

Which one of the following states has all of the above characteristics?

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Gujarat
(c) Karnataka (d) Tamil Nadu

Ans. (b): The northern part of the state of Gujarat is dry and semi-arid. Cotton is grown in its Central region and here, cash or commercial crops are cultivated more than food crops. Its present existence (Gujarat) came on 1 May, 1960. It is situated on the west coast of India. The main crops grown here are Cotton and Groundnut.

• Monsoon, Forest, Soil, Irrigation Projects and Agriculture

18. With reference to micro-irrigation , which of the following statements is/are correct ?

1. **Fertilizer/nutrient loss can be reduced**
2. **It is the only means of irrigation in dry land farming**
3. **In some areas of farming, receding of ground water table can be checked**

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c): The Micro irrigation system is one of the excellent modern techniques of irrigation. This can reduce fertilizer/nutrient loss from the soil and prevent groundwater levels in some agricultural areas.

• Minerals, Power Resources, Industries and Trade

19. Among the following State, which one has the most suitable climatic conditions for the cultivation of a large variety of orchids with minimum cost of production, and can develop and export oriented industry in this field ?

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Uttar Pradesh

Ans. (b) : The state of Arunachal Pradesh has the best climatic conditions, which can lead to the cultivation of various varieties of orchids and export- oriented industries can be developed here. Arunachal Pradesh is emerging as a major tourist region in north-eastern India. It is considered to be a treasure of nature and home to a variety of orchids.

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

• Universe and Solar System

20. An artificial satellite orbiting around the Earth does not fall down. This is so because the attraction of Earth–

(a) Does not exist at such distance.
(b) Is neutralized by the attraction of the moon.
(c) Provides the necessary speed for its steady motion.
(d) Provides the necessary acceleration for its motion.

Ans. (d) : We observe weightlessness in satellites because the net magnitude of the force on the body is almost zero. i.e. earth's gravitation is nullified in terms of magnitude by centrifugal force. But, earth's gravitation is necessary to change the direction of the satellite continuously and thus providing the acceleration in terms of change in direction.

21. What is the difference between asteroids and comets?

1. **Asteroids are small rocky planetoids, while comets are formed of frozen gases held together by rocky and metallic material.**
2. **Asteroids are found mostly between the orbits of Jupiter and Mars, while comets are found mostly between Venus and Mercury.**
3. **Comets show a perceptible glowing tail, while asteroids do not.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): The main difference between asteroids and comets lies mainly in their composition. Both were formed during the early phase of the solar system. Asteroids mainly consist of rocky and metallic material, while comets comprise ice, frozen gases, dust and rocky and metallic material. Asteroids are found nearer to the Sun, while comets are found farther from the Sun as the heat can melt any comet's ice. In fact, when a comet approaches the Sun, it starts losing its ice because of the Sun's heat, as a result of which a perceptible glowing tail can be seen.